RESEARCH & PROTOTYPE REVIEW

Field Visit & Stakeholder Consultation Report

Public office desk research, proposed visit plan, question guide and honest evidence template.

SIH 2026 | PS SIH26250 | Alchemy Architects

SOURCE-CODE REVIEW + PUBLIC RESEARCH | 20 OCTOBER 2026

ALCHEMY ARCHITECTS

IMPORTANT STATUS: PRE-VISIT / DESK RESEARCH ONLY. No physical visits, interviews, office endorsements or staff statements were evidenced in the materials supplied for this report. This document is a visit plan, publicly sourced office brief and fill-in report template. Complete the observation fields only after the team actually visits or holds an authorized meeting.

Purpose and scope

The SIH26250 challenge is defence-related, but student teams should not assume access to military sites, operational records or restricted areas. The proposed visits focus first on relevant, publicly accessible civil aviation, airport operations, and meteorological organisations to understand general data provenance, coordination, service continuity, public weather products and administrative workflows. These are useful analogues, not substitutes for authorized Ministry of Defence stakeholder validation.

1. Proposed offices and why they are relevant

Office / institution	Publicly supported relevance	Consultation topics to request	Evidence status
Airports Authority of India (AAI), Madurai Airport	Official AAI listing provides airport director, terminal manager and operations/safety contacts. [1]	Generic airport operations coordination, public-data workflow, disruption communication, non-sensitive cargo/turnaround context and safety review. Ask only for information they are permitted to share.	PROPOSED. Not visited.
India Meteorological Department (IMD), Regional Meteorological Centre Chennai	Official centre publishes observations, forecasts, nowcasts and regional weather services; AIP India identifies IMD as civil aviation meteorological service provider. [2][3]	Observation vs forecast distinction, timestamps, update cycles, quality flags, stale-feed handling, public access and data terms.	PROPOSED. Not visited.
AAI Civil Aviation Training College (CATC), Prayagraj	Official training page describes ATM and CNS training facilities including simulators/labs. [4]	General human factors, training simulators, systems coordination and why decision-support must preserve human oversight.	PROPOSED. Not visited.
Indian Aviation Academy / approved civil aviation training provider	Potential source of public educational context on airport operations, safety and training. Confirm current programmes/contact details before outreach.	How training scenarios represent constraints, roles, communication and after-action review.	OPTIONAL. Contact/availability not verified here.
Defence Services Staff College / authorized MoD liaison	Direct PS-owner validation would be most relevant, but access requires appropriate formal permission and may be unavailable.	Only authorized, non-sensitive problem clarification and safe scope; no operational or restricted records requested.	FORMAL CHANNEL ONLY. No visit or endorsement claimed.

2. Desk-research findings (public sources only)

- AAI publicly describes responsibilities covering airport development/operation, terminals, cargo facilities and air navigation services. These are appropriate civil-sector contexts for studying coordination and data freshness, but do not establish how a military command process works. [5]
- AAI lists a public Airport Director contact for Madurai Airport. Use official channels to request a meeting in advance; public contact listing is not a visit authorisation. [1]
- IMD RMC Chennai provides regional observations, nowcasts and forecasts; its public page lists weather enquiry/data-related contact routes. Confirm data permissions and terms before collecting or redistributing any feed. [2]
- AIP India states civil aviation meteorological services are provided by IMD. Weather can therefore be investigated as a public civil-data input and generic disruption variable. It cannot be treated as military clearance. [3]
- AAI CATC documents ATM and CNS training infrastructure, including simulator and communication/navigation/surveillance training. This is relevant to human-in-the-loop systems and training design. [4]
- NASA C-MAPSS is a simulated commercial turbofan degradation benchmark suitable for a bounded predictive-maintenance experiment only after checking the exact dataset and attribution. It is not defence-engine telemetry. [6]

3. Suggested visit schedule and responsibilities

Step	Owner	Action / deliverable	Status
1. Request permission	Team lead	Send concise student project request to public office contact; include college letter and intended questions.	Not started
2. Prepare safeguards	Team lead + documentation	One-page scope statement; no photography/recording unless explicitly permitted; no sensitive data requested.	Not started
3. Conduct discussion	Two members maximum or office preference	Ask about public non-sensitive process, systems, records, source timestamps and generic disruption handling.	Not completed
4. Record evidence	Documentation lead	Capture date/time, office, role of interviewee, consent and agreed notes; avoid names unless approved.	Not completed
5. Validate notes	All attendees	Read back key points where appropriate; separate direct quote from team inference.	Not completed
6. Map to prototype	Technical lead	Convert insights into requirements and acceptance tests without exposing restricted information.	Not completed

4. Fill-in visit record - complete after the actual visit

Field	Record after visit
Office/institution and public address	_____
Visit date, start/end time	_____
Team members who attended	_____
Permission / appointment reference	_____
Contact role (name only with permission)	_____
Purpose agreed by host	_____
Observation 1 + evidence reference	_____ _____
Observation 2 + evidence reference	_____ _____
Questions answered / unanswered	_____ _____
Follow-up requested / permitted artefacts	_____
Photographs / recording permission	None / Yes (describe exact permission and limits)
Prepared by / date / reviewer	_____

5. Questions to ask (safe, non-sensitive)

- What public record sources are authoritative for the specific information being discussed, and what timestamps identify observation time vs retrieval time?
- How are stale, missing or contradictory records identified and escalated? Are records ever explicitly marked unknown?
- Which types of operational changes are usually communicated across teams at a generic process level, and which are outside the public discussion scope?
- What would make a decision-support dashboard useful without replacing authorized human judgement?
- What public datasets, documentation, or training materials can the office recommend, and what are the applicable use/redistribution terms?
- May the team quote a general observation in an academic project? What attribution or review is required?

Do not submit this document as proof of completed visits. Once an actual visit occurs, replace this status notice, fill the visit record and attach consented evidence such as appointment correspondence, an approved visit photograph or a signed note if provided. Never fabricate an official letter, signature, endorsement or staff quotation.

References and source notes

[1] Airports Authority of India - Madurai Airport contacts
https://www.aai.aero/en/airports/contact-us/madurai
Official public contact details for the Airport Director office and terminal manager; proposed consultation target only, not evidence of a visit.

[2] India Meteorological Department - RMC Chennai
https://mausam.imd.gov.in/chennai/
Official regional weather observations, nowcasts, forecasts and public contact details; proposed consultation target only.

[3] AIP India - Meteorological Services
https://aim-india.aai.aero/eAIP_Archive/19-03-2026/eAIP/IN-GEN%203.5-en-GB.html
AIP India states that civil aviation meteorological services are provided by IMD; use for high-level context only.

[4] AAI Civil Aviation Training College - Contact
https://catc.aai.aero/en/contact
Official address and contact information for the Civil Aviation Training College, Prayagraj.

[5] AAI Civil Aviation Training College - Training Infrastructure
https://catc.aai.aero/en/training-infrastructure
Official description of air traffic management and communication/navigation/surveillance training infrastructure.

[6] Ministry of Civil Aviation - Airports Authority of India
https://www.civilaviation.gov.in/node/4093
Government overview of AAI responsibilities for airports, air navigation services, terminals and cargo facilities.

[7] NASA Prognostics Center of Excellence Dataset Repository
https://www.nasa.gov/intelligent-systems-division/discovery-and-systems-health/pcoe/pcoe-data-set-repository/
Official NASA repository lists turbofan engine degradation simulation data and the C-MAPSS benchmark. It is not military telemetry.